Unit – 5

Hello! I'm Santhiya. I want to write about my mobile phone. I got it from my parents for my birthday two years back. I like it very much and I think it's sometimes good to have it in my bag.

I always keep it in my bag or in my pocket so my parents and my friends can always call me. It's got a calculator in it so I use it frequently to calculate. It's also a kind of information file. I can use my mobile phone to connect to the Internet and look through the news or read emails. Isn't it fantastic?

Last year I was cycling with my friend on a holiday with my friend. We went cycling but the weather wasn't good. It was cold and windy. It started to rain and it got dark. Suddenly my friend fell off her bike and broke her leg. At first I didn't know what to do but then I thought about my phone. It was in my backpack so I telephoned for help. After fifteen minutes a doctor arrived.

Sometimes people are not keen on mobile phones. They are a real problem because they always ring at the wrong moment. I'm not crazy about my mobile phone but I feel safe when I have it with me.

Unit – 6

It must have been eight years ago. I was at Thiruvarur to attend the Nel Thiruvizha (seed festival) organised by Jayaraman.

I went there to volunteer; I'd heard about him from organic farming pioneer G. Nammalvar and wanted to see if we could bring the varieties Jayaraman revived, to the market.

It was just a small affair then; some people attended. But the festival grew exponentially from then on; from 500, the number of participants went up to 1,500 next year; and then to 2,500, 5,000… there was no looking back. When I entered the village Adhirangam where the festival took place, I saw men carrying sacks of paddy, they came with five kilograms and returned with 10 kilograms the next year. That was how the seed exchange worked.

I remember how Jayaraman cycled across villages to find traditional paddy seeds and distribute them. I asked him how he planned to carry his vision forward; what would he do for funds. But he replied, "What do I need funds for ? I have seeds and my cycle will take me to everywhere. Or I'll take a bus".

If people called him asking for his number of varieties of seeds, he went directly to see to it that they got what they wanted. I participated in the planning of his seed festivals.

But the man didn't believe that I was going by a strict plan. He was always cool when those around him panicked. For instance, if I told him there were many people

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